

Amal Nazeem

tomatotoaster.com • github.com/TomatoToaster • tomatotoaster.itch.io

EDUCATION

Northeastern University 2015–2018
Boston, MA
B.S. Computer Science and Mathematics
TA: Fundamentals of Computer Science I

SKILLS

Game Dev: GDScript (Godot), C# (Unity), Lua (Love2D), Blender, Aseprite
Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Kotlin, C++, Python, PHP, Java
Tools: React Native, React.js, Node.js, GraphQL, Temporal, Spring Boot, GCP, PostgreSQL

GAMES & PROJECTS

Web Developer: Punny-premised Spider-based Tower-defense Roguelite

Tools: Godot (GDScript), Aseprite

- Designed unique builder/traversal gameplay that challenges players to balance crafting, movement, and resource management in real time to defend the tower
- Created a colorful and playful visual style by maintaining full creative and technical control: coding all systems, drawing all the art/UI, and writing all character dialogue, without generative tools
- Blended comedic narrative beats with gameplay: enemies, web abilities, and hat upgrades are based on the central pun

Spilly Goose: Arcade Runner/Cafe-Sim for iOS & Android

Tools: Godot (GDScript), Aseprite

- Solo-developed a mobile game by designing and implementing fun gameplay systems, hand-drawn art, UI, and animation
- Designed intuitive tilt and touch controls and a dual-loop structure pairing the runner with a cafe meta-game for persistent progression and replayability
- Integrated with App Store and Google Play services for in-game leaderboards and TestFlight/Closed Track testing

Rainbee: Bee Colony Roguelike

Tools: Godot (GDScript), Aseprite, Unity (C#)

- Built a bee colony game in 3 days for a public jam, including all sprite drawing and tileset animation
- Expanded into a full roguelike with mobile-optimized controls and external player bug/feature tracking

WORK EXPERIENCE

Kale Jan 2024 – Feb 2026

New York, NY

Senior Software Engineer

- Longest-tenured engineer on the team: go-to resource for architecture decisions, technical mentoring, and onboarding
- Designed and shipped quests, photo/repost challenges, and in-app video uploads: direct analogues to game progression systems and live events
- Ideated new challenge formats to expand monetization options, applying game-design thinking to content loops
- Served on-call rotations to triage critical bugs, resolve customer issues, and maintain stability in a live product

Personal Sabbatical — Game Dev Focus Aug 2022 – Dec 2023

New York, NY

Independent Game Developer

- Completed Harvard's CS50G, recreating 12 classic games in Love2D and Unity to build foundational game dev skills
- Competed in public game jams, building proficiency in rapid prototyping, scoping, and iterating on feedback

Expensify July 2019 – Aug 2022

San Francisco, CA (Remote)

Software Engineer — Full Stack

- Led end-to-end technical design and delivery of Chat Rooms, a high-visibility real-time collaborative feature
- Shipped improvements to Per Diem and Mileage Expense flows, improving accuracy and UX for business travelers

Intuit (TurboTax) July 2017 – Dec 2017

San Diego, CA

Product Manager / Software Engineer Co-op

- Built reusable React modules for TurboTax's Visual Refresh initiative, published to npm for cross-team adoption
- Rewrote front-end test suite using Nightwatch, significantly cutting deployment cycle time
- Redesigned TurboTax Bookmarks based on customer research and produced a roadmap for future iteration